

Elements Dynasty

Incepto

Akansh floated in the endless darkness of space.

Tiny stars sparkled far away, but there was nothing around him except silence.

He opened his eyes suddenly. "Not again..." he thought.

He tried to scream, but no sound came out. He tried again and again. Nothing. Panic filled his chest.

Then a tiny black dot appeared before him. It was darker than the darkness itself.

Akansh slowly reached out and touched it with his right hand.

The dot expanded across the universe. Stars vanished one by one until only darkness remained.

Then a deep voice echoed from everywhere and nowhere. "This is my home, insect."

The darkness rushed toward him, flowing into his body through his right hand.

Akansh woke up with a gasp, clutching that same hand to his chest.

His heart was still racing as he looked around the room. The familiar sight of his ceiling fan spinning above him brought him back to reality while the faint morning sunlight slipped through the curtains spread across the room. Akansh sat silently on his bed for a few moments, trying to calm his breathing.

His mind was still trapped in the dream, the endless darkness, the vanishing stars, and that voice.

"Why do I keep seeing these dreams?" he whispered to himself. He glanced down at his right hand.

For a moment, he simply stared at it before shaking his head and letting out a small sigh.

"Just a dream," he muttered. He reached for his phone lying beside his pillow and checked the time.

8:30 AM. Sunday. A small smile appeared on his face. He pulled his blanket over himself and turned to the other side of the bed, ready to continue his interrupted sleep.

Before he could close his eyes, his mother's voice echoed through the house.

"Akansh! Wake up! If you're sleeping this late on a Sunday, at least help your dad!"

Akansh groaned and buried his face deeper into the pillow.

"Mom, please... It's Sunday. I want to sleep."

"I know it's Sunday," his mother replied immediately. "That's exactly why it's housework day, come downstairs, have your breakfast, and help your father to clean the storeroom."

Akansh let out a defeated sigh. "Fine... I'm coming." A few minutes later.

After freshening up and finishing his breakfast, Akansh followed his father toward the storeroom.

The moment he stepped inside, he regretted it immediately. Dust covered almost everything.

Old newspapers were piled up in one corner while broken toys from his childhood lay forgotten beneath a wooden shelf, rusty tools, old boxes, and objects nobody remembered owning anymore.

It felt less like a storeroom and more like a place where old memories had been abandoned.

As Akansh moved an old blanket aside, something caught his eye. A small rusty box. He picked it up.

The metal felt cold in his hands despite the warm morning air.

He brushed away the thick layer of dust covering its surface and examined it closely.

The box had no lock. No keyhole. No markings. Nothing. It was simply a silent black box resting in his hands. Akansh frowned once more. "I've never seen this before."

Akansh turned the box over in his hands once more, carefully examining every side.

The symbols carved into its surface were unlike anything he had ever seen before.

They were not English, Hindi, or any language he recognized.

Some looked like circles surrounded by red lines. Others resembled stars connected by strange patterns.

"Maybe it's just some antique thing," he said to himself. Curiosity quickly got the better of him.

He tried to pull the lid. Nothing happened. He tried pushing it instead. Still nothing.

He pressed against the sides, searched for a hidden button, and even shook it lightly near his ear. Nothing.

The box remained completely silent. "Seriously?" Akansh muttered.

"What kind of box doesn't even have a lock?"

After several more failed attempts, frustration began replacing curiosity.

Just then, his father walked into the storeroom carrying another old cardboard box.

"Found something interesting?" he asked. Akansh held up the rusty box.

"Dad, whose box is this? I've never seen it before."

His father looked at it for a moment before placing the cardboard box down beside him.

"Oh, that thing. You don't know about it?" His father looked at him. "Your grandfather found it many years ago while working in the fields. He brought it home thinking there might be something valuable inside." Akansh looked down at the box again. "So what was inside?"

His father laughed softly. "That's the funny part. Nobody knows." Akansh raised an eyebrow.

"What do you mean nobody knows?" "We tried opening it dozens of times," his father replied.

"Your grandfather tried. I tried. Even your uncle tried once using a screwdriver and a hammer."

Akansh looked at the box in surprise. "And?" "And nothing. It never opened." His father shrugged.

"Eventually, we gave up and threw it into the storeroom along with everything else."

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Akansh simply stared at the box resting quietly in his hands, no lock, no keyhole no way to open it, yet somehow, he couldn't shake the strange feeling that the box wanted him to keep trying, almost as if... it was waiting for someone, the strange symbols carved into its surface seemed almost alive under the thin layer of dust. "Dad," he said after a moment of silence, "can I keep it?"

His father looked at him in surprise. "The box?" Akansh replied.

"Yeah. I don't know why, but it feels interesting. Maybe I'll figure out how to open it someday."

His father chuckled. "If you can open it, you'll succeed where your grandfather, your uncle, and I failed."

Akansh smiled slightly. "Challenge accepted." His father laughed and shook his head.

"Fine, keep it if you want. It's been sitting here doing nothing for years anyway." "Thanks, Dad."

Carefully holding the box in both hands, Akansh walked out of the storeroom and headed to his room. As he walked towards his room, he glanced down at the strange symbols once more. For some reason he couldn't explain, but the box no longer felt like an old forgotten object from the storeroom, it felt important for him.

Akansh entered his room and placed the box on his study table beside his books and phone.

The morning sunlight from the window fell directly onto its surface, making the strange red symbols shine faintly for a brief moment. Akansh blinked. The glow disappeared. "Probably just the sunlight."

He pulled a chair closer and sat down in front of it. For a few moments, he simply stared at it in silence, the layer of dust covering it reminded him just how long it must have been lying forgotten in the storeroom. He picked up a napkin from his desk and wiped the dust away from its surface.

As the dust disappeared, strange red lines carved into circular patterns began to reveal themselves.

The markings spread across the box in perfect symmetry, connecting to one another like a puzzle.

Or a map. Under the faint sunlight entering through the window, the symbols almost seemed alive.

Akansh frowned. He had never seen anything like them before.

"What exactly are you?" he whispered. He picked the box up and turned it over in his hands.

There was no lock. No keyhole. No hinges. There was only a visible opening that looked like a lid.

"How does something like this even work?" he muttered.

Curiosity quickly turned into determination. He pressed one of the symbols with his thumb.

Nothing happened. He pressed another. Still nothing. One by one, he tried every symbol he could find.

Nothing. Akansh frowned and pulled at what looked like the lid. It didn't move even a millimeter.

He tried twisting it. Still nothing. He held it close to his ear and shook it, hoping to hear something moving inside. Silence. Not even the slightest sound came from within. "Great," he sighed.

"An indestructible metal cube." Determined not to lose a battle against an old piece of metal.

He tried again. He pushed it, pulled it, and pressed every symbol once more.

He even searched around its edges for a hidden switch or button. Nothing.

His eyes suddenly landed on the toolbox near his desk, and in a few moments he returned holding a hammer. "All right," he said confidently. "Let's see how strong you really are."

He tapped the box. The hammer vibrated in his hand. The box didn't even get a scratch.

Akansh stared at it. The hammer looked more damaged than the box. "Okay... that's unfair."

After several more minutes of failed attempts, he finally leaned back in his chair with a sigh of defeat.

"Fine," he said. "You win." He dropped the box onto the table and reached for his phone.

Almost immediately, a notification appeared on the screen.

Harshit: Bro, can you send me yesterday's notes?

Akansh replied: Of course, he muttered. "One Sunday I decided to rest."

He stood up and began searching through the books and papers scattered across his desk.

The mysterious box was taking up most of the space. Annoyed, he picked it up with his right hand to move it aside. His eyes fell on the strange red symbols one last time.

"What are you even made of, vibranium?" His right hand rested on the symbols.

Something happened. Then—click.

Akansh froze. Slowly... very slowly... he looked down. The lid had shifted. The box was open.

An ancient signal that has slept in silence for countless years awakens once again and spreads across the universe, unseen by all but felt by certain ones, those who knew of its existence felt it. Something changed.

They didn't know who had opened it... only that the seal had finally been broken after millions of years.

Not on Earth. Not in the Solar System. But across the universe itself. Far beyond the Earth, beyond the Moon, beyond the reach of human eyes, thousands of light-years away, near the edge of a dead world floating in the darkness of space, a ruined city stood beneath a sky without stars.

At its center stood a black throne. Upon that throne sat a giant shadow. Motionless. Silent. Watching.

The cold wind moved his long black cloak as he slowly lifted his head toward the sky.

For a few moments, he said nothing. Then, a faint smile appeared on his face.

"So... the Elements have finally chosen the unfortunate one."

His laughter echoed through the empty city. A deep, quiet laugh. Not of joy, but of anticipation.

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Then came the words that seemed to shake the darkness and reality itself. From the shadows, there was no surprise, no reaction, only the calm certainty of one who stood beyond the reach of the universe itself. His pure white eyes slowly opened, visible even through the shadows. "Exactly as it should be." The darkness returned, as though it had no choice but to obey Yean.

On a lonely planet, Gaur was sitting upon a cliff overlooking an ocean. The cold wind howled across the white landscape. Snow fell endlessly from the dark sky above. Yet Gaur remained perfectly still, meditating. Waiting.

Suddenly, Gaur stood up for the first time in many years, a look of worry appeared on his face. "The Elements..." he whispered. His voice disappeared into the cold wind.

"It has been opened." He turned his eyes toward the endless stars above him.

"After all these years... After all this waiting... It has finally come."

Without hesitation, he spoke into the empty air. "ED." A faint blue light appeared beside him. "Get ready." That faint blue light was a cloud of shimmering blue nanoparticles that gathered beside him, taking the graceful form of a young woman. "Everything is ready, Captain," ED replied with a smile.

For a few moments, Gaur's eyes remained fixed on the countless stars shining above the frozen planet.

"Prepare the ship." ED folded her hands behind her back.

"I already did. I knew you would say that. The ship has been ready for the last ten years... ever since the day you began waiting here." A faint smile appeared on Gaur's face. "You still count the years?"

"I count everything, Captain," ED replied. "The signal has been confirmed.

The Elemental Artifact has finally been activated for the first time in millions of years."

Gaur took one last look at the frozen planet that had been his home for ten years.

Endless sheets of snow stretched beyond the horizon, untouched by time.

The icy winds howled across the barren landscape, yet everything was peaceful.

Then a brilliant green beam of light suddenly descended from the sky, surrounding Gaur from head to toe. In milliseconds, his body dissolved into countless particles and vanished from the planet.

ED's voice echoed in the spacecraft. "Transport sequence complete. Welcome aboard, Captain."

Gaur was in a spacecraft. He stepped onto the command deck and walked toward the main control panel. The massive transparent screen before him came to life. He asked ED, "Show me."

The lights dimmed as a three-dimensional map of the universe appeared before him. Billions of stars filled the display, while one tiny point pulsed with a bright golden circle.

ED materialized beside the console. "Target located," she said. "Designation: CG-o.7."

Gaur chuckled. "So... the Baby Planet."

"There are over seven thousand billion inhabited planets within the known universe,"

ED replied. "Referring to one of them as 'Baby Planet' is statistically inefficient."

Gaur crossed his arms with a smile. "You and your classifications." He looked at the glowing point on the map. "They haven't achieved interstellar travel... they aren't united under a single planetary government... and they haven't mastered stable energy systems." ED paused for a second before replying, "Scientifically speaking... CG-o.7 remains the correct designation."

Gaur laughed quietly. "Fine. You win this one." Then ED's expression became serious.

"Captain... we are no longer the only ones aware that the Elemental Artifact has been opened, Others will have sensed it as well." Gaur's smile faded. "I know." He fixed his eyes on the highlighted world.

"Then let's not keep destiny waiting." The engines roared to life as the spacecraft turned toward CG-o.7, beginning a journey that would change the fate of the universe forever. Meanwhile, on Earth,

Akansh heard that click and realized the box had finally opened. His eyes widened.

Slowly, he bent down and stared at the mysterious box. "It... opened?"

Unable to believe his eyes, he carefully lifted the lid. This time, it opened without any resistance.

Inside rested a beautiful green stone, glowing with a soft light. It wasn't dazzling, yet it wasn't ordinary either. The glow filled the inside of the box, making the stone seem strangely alive.

Akansh couldn't take his eyes off it. "What... is this?" For a moment, he simply stared at it.

Then suddenly... "Mom! Dad!" he shouted excitedly. "Come here quickly!"

His voice echoed through the house. "What happened?" his father asked as he hurried toward the room.

His mother followed behind him. Akansh pointed excitedly at the box. "Look! The box finally opened!"

His parents looked at each other in surprise. "The black box?" his father asked.

"Yes, the same box Grandpa found years ago! It finally opened!"

His father stepped forward with curiosity. "Move aside."

He reached for the lid and tried to open it. Nothing. He frowned and pulled harder.

Still nothing. His mother tried next. She twisted it, pushed it, and even tried lifting it from another side.

The box remained completely sealed. Both of them looked at Akansh.

"Akansh..." his father said, "It's still closed." Akansh blinked. "What? No... it was open! I just saw it!"

His father placed the box on the table. "See? It's still sealed," he said. Akansh shook his head.

"No... it really opened." He suddenly remembered how it had happened the first time.

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"I didn't even pull the lid..." Both his parents looked at him with confused expressions. "I just... placed my hand on it." Akansh rested his hand on top of the mysterious box. He waited. Nothing. He pressed his hand against it longer. Still nothing. Silence filled the room. His mother sighed. "See? We told you. It's just the same old box." His father nodded. "You're probably exhausted after cleaning all morning. Get some rest." Akansh looked down at the box. "Maybe..." His parents smiled and walked out of the room, closing the door behind them. The room became completely silent. Akansh continued staring at the box. "It doesn't make any sense..." He walked toward it once again. "It really opened before..." He placed his hand on the box one more time. Then—click. Akansh froze. His eyes widened. The sound echoed through the silent room. The box was unlocked. His heart raced as he slowly lifted the lid. The glowing green stone rested inside exactly as before. He looked toward the closed door. "They were just here..." His parents had watched him do the exact same thing. Nothing had happened. But the moment they left the box opened. A strange feeling crept over him. It was almost as if the box had been waiting until he was alone. Akansh reached inside the box and picked up the glowing green stone. It fit perfectly in the palm of his hand. The stone felt smooth and almost polished. A coldness spread through his fingers, but apart from that, nothing seemed unusual. He turned it over. Nothing. No symbols. No hidden button. No strange markings. Only a soft green glow. "Hmm..." He frowned. "So much mystery just for a stone?" Curiosity refused to leave him. He held it closer to his eyes, examining every tiny detail. Still nothing. He even tapped it with his fingernail. The sound was exactly like an ordinary stone. "This is disappointing." He sighed. "I thought something amazing would happen with the stone, like it did with the box." With a small shrug, he placed the glowing stone back inside the box. The moment it touched the bottom, the glow faded within seconds. The stone looked completely ordinary. Akansh blinked. "Wait..." He picked it up again. The glow returned instantly. He placed it back. The light disappeared. He repeated it once more. Glow. Darkness. Glow. Darkness..... "Okay..." A smile appeared on his face. "So you're also interesting." Completely unaware of what had truly happened. Akansh placed the glowing stone back inside the box and closed the lid. He slid the mysterious box beneath the table. The rest of the evening passed like any other day. Dinner with his parents. A little conversation. Nothing unusual. Yet, every few minutes, his thoughts drifted back to the strange box beneath the table. Why didn't it open in front of mom and dad? Why only for me? He had no answers. As night fell, Akansh switched off the lights and lay down on his bed. Outside, the wind whispered through the trees. Within minutes, he drifted into a deep sleep. Completely unaware that, at that very moment, a spacecraft was approaching the CG-O.7. Years before Akansh ever found the box. The night sky was clear, and the fields lay silent under the moonlight. Without warning. A blazing object tore across the sky and crashed into the farm with a deafening impact. The next morning, Akansh's grandfather walked through the fields and noticed a massive crater that hadn't been there the day before. At the center of it rested a strange black box surrounded by red lines. The impact had scorched the surrounding soil, making it obvious that whatever had landed there had come from far beyond Earth. Curious yet cautious, he climbed into the crater and carefully picked up the box. It was surprisingly cold to the touch and unlike anything he had ever seen. There was no lock, no hinge, and no visible opening. He tried everything he could to open it, but it refused to budge. Over the following years, every member of the family tried. They pushed, pulled, struck, and examined it from every angle, yet the mysterious box remained completely sealed. Eventually, they accepted defeat. Believing it to be nothing more than an unsolved mystery, they placed it in the old storeroom. Where it sat untouched for years... waiting. Until one ordinary day, Akansh placed his hand on its surface. With a faint glow, the impossible finally happened. The box was open. And now... The next morning, sunlight streamed through Akansh's bedroom window, waking him from his sleep. He was lying on his bed, staring at the ceiling. Then he remembered the mysterious black box. Without wasting another second, he got out of bed and looked beneath the table. The box was still there. "So... it wasn't a dream."